

Chapter 6 - Dream Return

The two girls looked at each other, and both saw a hint of surprise in the other's eyes.

At this moment, Feng Yue, who had long harbored feelings for Yan Lin, showed a touch of joy on her face.

The Yan Lin of this time hadn't yet grown into the cold, aloof beauty of later years. She could only be considered a quiet little beauty who was serious and spoke little.

"You're here too," Feng Yue was the first to come back to her senses, curving her eyes and smiling at the other girl.

Yan Lin nodded without speaking, and silently moved aside to make room on the spot where she had been sitting.

She remembered Fu Sixue mentioning that Feng Yue, who had performed with her, had also recently received many love letters and gifts.

Like her, the other girl had come to the rooftop to hide from people.

Seeing her action, the smile on Feng Yue's face deepened. She took a few quick steps over and sat down beside Yan Lin.

While opening her lunch box, Feng Yue glanced toward Yan Lin's food—all light, plain dishes. Then she looked at her own lunch box, which was a vibrant red throughout.

Feng Yue was silent for two seconds, then asked: "Do you always eat such bland food?"

The moment Feng Yue opened her lunch box, Yan Lin smelled the almost overwhelming aroma of chili peppers. Having eaten light food for years, she couldn't help but frown slightly upon smelling it.

Feng Yue didn't notice her reaction and continued: "Would you like to try some of my dishes? Our housekeeper is from Sichuan-Chongqing¹ area, specially found by my mom. She's really skilled at cooking."

"Thank you, but no need," Yan Lin looked at the bright red spread and felt somewhat resistant. "I'm not used to very spicy food."

"That's fine. Next time when there's a chance, I can have you try some non-spicy dishes our housekeeper makes—they're also delicious."

Yan Lin neither agreed nor disagreed, just nodded silently. She knew that Sichuan-Chongqing people's "not spicy" and "mildly spicy" were absolutely not to be trusted!

The two ate quietly without talking. After a while, Yan Lin put down her chopsticks, quietly tidied up her utensils, then sat there silently.

Feng Yue had thought the other girl would leave after eating, so when she realized Yan Lin might be waiting for her to finish, she quickly accelerated her eating pace.

Soon she also put down her chopsticks, though looking at the considerable amount of food still remaining in her lunch box, she silently wept inside.

There was still a long time left in the lunch break. Feng Yue wanted to chat more with Yan Lin, so she took the initiative to start a conversation.

"By the way, I never asked—how did you think to come eat lunch on the rooftop?" Feng Yue leaned back against the chair back, her small feet swinging back and forth on the stool.

Yan Lin looked at the time—it was still early, so she decided to chat with Feng Yue, though she still spoke very little.

"Fu Sixue recommended this place to me. She said there are few people here."

"Fu Sixue? Is she a classmate from your class?"

"Mm." Yan Lin thought for a moment and replied. Fu Sixue was indeed her classmate, and even her deskmate.

"I see. So you must have received a lot of love letters too." Feng Yue looked up at the clear blue sky, trying hard to control her tone so it wouldn't sound too sour.

This seemed to trigger some memory in Yan Lin. Her expression twisted for a moment, then quickly returned to normal as she nodded: "Mm, many."

Feng Yue silently pursed her lips, then sat up straight in her chair and turned to face Yan Lin with a serious expression: "Yan Lin, no matter how many people write you love letters, you absolutely cannot have puppy love²!"

Yan Lin was somewhat surprised by her sudden seriousness, but under Feng Yue's intense gaze, she still nodded in agreement, and then the corner of her mouth curved into a faint smile.

Feng Yue had spent about a week with her, but this was the first time she had seen Yan Lin smile.

So beautiful, Yan Lin...

Feng Yue seemed to be burned by that faint smile and quickly turned her gaze away, muttering: "What are you smiling about? We're just in middle school—we really shouldn't have puppy love."

"I thought you were the type who would have puppy love," Yan Lin thought for a moment, then said.

"No way! If you don't have puppy love, then I won't either." Feng Yue said the latter half quietly, and it was unclear whether Yan Lin heard it.

The two chatted about things happening in their respective classes afterward, though most of the time it was Feng Yue talking while Yan Lin listened quietly.

Brilliant sunlight shone down on the two young girls in their youth. Occasionally a breeze would blow, lifting the fine strands of hair by their cheeks, and those strands would dance and intertwine tightly in the wind.

The scene from the dream was still clearly visible, as if those memories had never faded from Feng Yue's mind.

She opened her eyes and stared blankly at the familiar ceiling of her room. The moment she awakened from the dream, Feng Yue knew that letting go of her feelings for Yan Lin might be more difficult than she had imagined.

After staying at her parents' house for a few days, Feng Yue had roughly adapted to her reborn life.

This morning, Feng Yue got up early to pack her luggage. It was time to return. If she stayed any longer, her mother might suspect there were relationship problems between her and Yan Lin.

However, this time Feng Yue didn't take much luggage with her. After her divorce from Yan Lin, those clothes would have to be brought back sooner or later anyway, so there was no need to take them now.

After breakfast and saying goodbye to her parents, Feng Yue took a taxi directly to her destination: the hospital.

She had an appointment with Professor Fang today. The professor had developed a detailed treatment plan for her condition, and if progress went smoothly, it wouldn't affect her life in the future.

As for why she was being so proactive about treatment, that was thanks to a phone call from Dai Shuangshuang a few days ago.

During their casual chat, Dai Shuangshuang had mentioned the kidnapped girl's situation.

According to what she learned later, that girl was incredibly lucky. Shortly after her parents reported the case to police, concerned citizens anonymously reported a gathering place for human traffickers.

When police investigated, they discovered that this group of traffickers was exactly the gang that had kidnapped that girl.

Moreover, according to Dai Shuangshuang, the results for those traffickers came out quickly, with sentences almost at the maximum for similar crimes.

Because this incident caused almost no harm to that girl, Dai Shuangshuang felt inexplicably relieved when talking about it.

But only Feng Yue knew what Dai Shuangshuang had experienced in her previous life, which was why she had made that anonymous call when she learned someone was still kidnapped.

As for the unusually swift processing and results for these criminals, she attributed it to some butterfly effect brought about by her rebirth and didn't think much more about it.

So after learning that avoiding certain events could change fate, she became very interested in the treatment plan Professor Fang proposed.

After all, no one truly wants to die.

She wanted to live, to complete the bucket list she hadn't finished in her previous life.

Professor Fang's treatment plan was conservative. Generally, it involved first using medication to stabilize Feng Yue's condition, then removing the tumor from her brain at an appropriate time to prevent the cancer cells from spreading.

Feng Yue had no objections to any of this, so when she left the hospital, she was carrying quite a few medications.

When Feng Yue returned to the small villa she shared with Yan Lin, she had just pushed open the door when she saw someone who shouldn't have been in the living room.

Feng Yue stood in the doorway, one hand carrying a bag of medicine, the other gripping the door handle tightly.

The person in the living room also heard the sound and looked up at her.

Long black curls cascaded like seaweed over her shoulders. She wore a simple, crisp white shirt and apricot-colored fitted trousers.

Inexplicably, Feng Yue saw in this person the Yan Lin who had sat in the art classroom playing piano twelve years ago.

Back then, they were just like now—one in the room, one standing at the door.

This one glance seemed to span a thousand years.

Feng Yue stood frozen in place. Her gaze crossed time, penetrated space, and looked directly at this young Yan Lin.

Feng Yue was the first to break the silence. Almost the moment she came back to her senses, she withdrew her gaze and unconsciously tried to hide the medicine she was carrying behind her back.

She closed the door and walked quietly into the house, seeming to consider what to chat about with Yan Lin.

At this moment, Yan Lin was still staring at Feng Yue without blinking.

How long had it been since she had seen these eyes?

One year? Two years?

Yan Lin couldn't remember. She only knew it had been a very, very long time—so long she had almost forgotten the light that danced in these eyes when they looked at her.

"How did you come back?" Feng Yue's voice was very soft.

Yan Lin's voice was still as always—calm and flat: "Finished dealing with things."

Hearing this, Feng Yue froze in place, quietly standing with her back to Yan Lin. After a while, Yan Lin saw her seem to take a deep breath and say: "That's good."

What had she been expecting? An apology for their anniversary? Or that Yan Lin had come home early to make up for missing their anniversary? Feng Yue thought silently.

After putting away the bag of medicine, Feng Yue slowly walked toward the living room: "Will you be eating at home?"

"I—" Just as Yan Lin opened her mouth, the doorbell rang.

Feng Yue saw a flash of annoyance cross the other's face and seemed to understand something. Without saying much, she got up to answer the door.

As expected, it was Yan Lin's secretary, Mo Yixu.

He wasn't surprised to see her, just nodded slightly to greet Feng Yue.

"Madam, sorry to disturb you."

Feng Yue nodded slightly at him, then gestured for him to come in.

However, Yan Lin in the house didn't look very pleased at this moment.

She had returned early this time because, having experience from her previous life, the cooperation abroad had gone very smoothly.

But perhaps due to the butterfly effect, there had been some unexpected developments on their side, and she still needed to fly over there tonight.

Mo Yixu, having been Yan Lin's secretary for the longest time, could easily tell that his boss was in a genuinely bad mood.

Connecting this to Yan Lin's hurried return to the country, he roughly understood the situation.

It seemed there were some problems between the CEO and his wife.

When Feng Yue saw Mo Yixu, she understood that Yan Lin wouldn't be staying home long. Perhaps she had just come back to get something, or perhaps just for a brief rest.

In any case, she definitely hadn't come home for her sake.

¹ Sichuan-Chongqing area (川渝地区) - Refers to Sichuan Province and Chongqing Municipality in southwestern China, famous for extremely spicy cuisine featuring Sichuan peppercorns and chili peppers.

² Puppy love (早恋) - A Chinese term referring to romantic relationships among teenagers, which is traditionally discouraged in Chinese culture, especially in academic settings where students are expected to focus on their studies.